Danlin Zeng

MD Candidate 2027 · University of British Columbia
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Education

Doctor of Medicine (MD) Candidate
2023 – 2027 (expected)

University of British Columbia, Vancouver, BC

Master of Science, Biochemistry
2021 – 2023

McGill University, Montréal, QC · Supervisor: Dr. Morag Park

- Thesis: Targeting chemotherapy-induced senescence escape to reduce breast cancer cell survival

Bachelor of Science, Physiology and Pharmacology
2017 – 2021

University of Toronto, Toronto, ON

- 3.98 cumulative GPA
- Minor in Economics. Additional coursework in Python, bioinformatics, and statistics

Awards & scholarships

ESCRS Bursary Award
2026

European Society of Cataract & Refractive Surgeons (ESCRS)

Competitive bursary for the highest-scoring abstracts

Conquer Cancer Merit Award
2026

American Society of Clinical Oncology (ASCO) Annual Meeting

One of 141 merit awards among over 8,500 abstracts submitted worldwide

Conquer Cancer Merit Award
2026

ASCO Quality Care Symposium

One of 48 top-ranking abstracts selected among over 900 abstracts

Summer Student Research Program Award
2024

Faculty of Medicine, University of British Columbia

Undergraduate Student Research Award
2021

Natural Sciences and Engineering Research Council of Canada (NSERC)

Undergraduate Scholarships
2018 – 2021

University of Toronto

Dr. James A. & Connie P. Dickson Scholarship (2020, 2021)
Alen Milne McCombie Scholarship (2019)
Mary McWhorter Scholarship (2018)

Publications

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

01 **Zeng D**, Bondok M, Tao B, Al-Ghoul A, Pintwala R. Ocular adverse events associated with taxane chemotherapy: a disproportionality analysis of pharmacovigilance data. *Journal of Ocular Pharmacology and Therapeutics.* Accepted for publication Sept 29, 2026.

02 **Zeng D**, Bates A, Zhang Y, Cook O, Raman S, Leung B, Ho C, Nunez JJ. The impact of social isolation and psychological distress on overall survival in cancer: a population-based cohort study. *JCO Oncology Practice.* Accepted for publication Aug 24, 2026.

03 Sagorin Z, **Zeng D**, Nguyen N, Yorke E, Sampath S. Intracorporeal anastomosis versus extracorporeal anastomosis for laparoscopic right hemicolectomy: short-term and long-term outcomes. *Surgical Endoscopy.* Published online Jul 13, 2026.
doi.org/10.1007/s00464-026-13128-2

04 Yang K, Li M, Skinner T, **Zeng D**, Sosa G, Han JY, Jafarian F. A dietary approach to skin cancer prevention in solid organ transplant recipients: a perspective. *Frontiers in Transplantation.* Accepted for publication Sept 24, 2026.

05 Yang K, Mircescu A, Okusanya D, Mohsen S, **Zeng D**, Czyz S, Vallerand I, Damiani G, Bunick C, Jafarian F. Understanding the atopic dermatitis–psoriasis phenotypic switch through a pharmacovigilance-based approach. *Journal of Investigative Dermatology.* Published online Jun 1, 2026.
doi.org/10.1016/j.jid.2026.05.012

MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW

06 Kang M, Dhesa P, Dhillon R, **Zeng D**, Dhillon H, Uppal M, Gill K, Tao B, Navajas E. Regional trends in ophthalmic surgical wait times 2009–2024 in British Columbia, Canada: a retrospective study of the BC Surgical Wait Times dataset. *Canadian Journal of Ophthalmology.* Submitted Aug 2026.

07 **Zeng D**, Wu E, Derocher H, Lin A, Siever J, Rao S, Lin T, Sit D, Murchison S, Sauciuc D, Atrchian S. Long-term outcomes and patterns of care in thymoma: a provincial cohort study. *Lung Cancer.* Submitted Sept 2026.
Preprint

08 **Zeng D**, Ho A, Bondy S, Kong P, Cunningham J, Sidi S, Lee G, Kapoor V, Nakajima L, Sapkota D. Improving sexual and reproductive health knowledge in a low-income rural community: the adolescent health program. *Global Health: Science and Practice.* Submitted Sept 2026.

09 Sagorin Z, **Zeng D**, Nguyen N, Yorke E, Sampath S. Pfannenstiel versus midline extraction in laparoscopic right hemicolectomy with intracorporeal anastomosis: association with ileus, hernia, and infection risk. *BMC Surgery.* Submitted May 2026.
Preprint

10 Li K, **Zeng D**, Thapar A, Belayneh M. Managing neuropathic cancer breakthrough pain for patients on methadone: a retrospective cohort study. *Journal of Pain & Palliative Care Pharmacotherapy.* Submitted Jul 2026.

11 Yuan L, **Zeng D**, Atrchian S, Clarke K, Sulpher J. Clinical outcomes of rectal squamous cell carcinoma in British Columbia, Canada. *Journal of Gastrointestinal Cancer.* Submitted Jun 2026.

12 Lee AH, Kruger HJ, Chen J, **Zeng D**, Narayanan D, Oosthuizen G, Hameed SM. Current priorities and gaps in artificial intelligence for global trauma care. *Journal of Trauma and Acute Care Surgery.* Submitted Aug 2026.

Conference presentations

28 presentations in total: 14 oral, 14 poster. Presenting author underlined.

ORAL

01 **Zeng D**, Wong VT, Pintwala R. Acute angle-closure glaucoma and non-ophthalmic anticholinergics: a sex-stratified pharmacovigilance disproportionality analysis.

> *European Society of Cataract & Refractive Surgeons (ESCRS) Congress*, London, UK, Sept 2026 5-MIN ORAL
> ESCRS BURSARY AWARD

02 **Zeng D**, Bondok M, Tao B, Al-Ghoul A, Pintwala R. Ocular adverse events associated with taxane chemotherapy: a disproportionality analysis of pharmacovigilance data and a literature review.

> *Pan-American Association of Ophthalmology (PAAO) Research Day*, Virtual, Aug 2026 3-MIN ORAL

03 **Zeng D**, Bates A, Zhang Y, Cook O, Raman S, Leung B, Ho C, Nunez JJ. Association of social isolation with overall survival in cancer patients.

> *American Society of Clinical Oncology (ASCO) Annual Meeting*, Chicago, IL, May 2026 6-MIN ORAL
> CONQUER CANCER MERIT AWARD

04 **Zeng D**, Ho A, Bondy S, Kong P, Cunningham J, Sidi S, Lee G, Kapoor V, Nakajima L, Sapkota D. Improving sexual and reproductive health literacy among adolescent girls in rural Nepal.

> *Western Medical Research Conference*, Carmel, CA, Jan 2025 10-MIN ORAL
> *UBC FLEX Activity Day*, Vancouver, BC, Jan 2025 1-MIN ORAL

05 Sagorin Z, **Zeng D**, Nguyen N, Yorke E, Sampath S. Intracorporeal versus extracorporeal anastomosis for laparoscopic right hemicolectomy: short-term and long-term outcomes.

> *British Columbia Surgical Society*, Victoria, BC, May 2024 15-MIN ORAL
> *UBC Department of Surgery Chung Research Day*, Vancouver, BC, Nov 2024 4-MIN ORAL

06 Li K, **Zeng D**, Thapar A, Belayneh M. Managing neuropathic cancer breakthrough pain for patients on methadone: a retrospective cohort study.

> *Canadian Society of Palliative Medicine*, Virtual, Sept 2025 10-MIN ORAL
> *UBC Division of Palliative Care Research Day*, Vancouver, BC, Jun 2025 15-MIN ORAL

07 Sagorin Z, **Zeng D**, Nguyen N, Yorke E, Sampath S. Postoperative incisional hernia rates comparing midline versus Pfannenstiel extraction site for laparoscopic right hemicolectomy with intracorporeal anastomosis.

> *British Columbia Surgical Society*, Kelowna, BC, Apr 2025 15-MIN ORAL

08 Yuan L, **Zeng D**, Atrchian S, Clarke K, Sulpher J. Clinical outcomes of rectal squamous cell carcinoma in British Columbia, Canada.

> *Western Medical Students Summit*, Calgary, AB, Feb 2025 7-MIN ORAL

09 **Zeng D**, Fortier AM, Park M. Targeting chemo-resistant triple-negative breast cancer.

> *Biochemistry Graduate Student Society Research Day, McGill University*, Montréal, QC, Apr 2022 3-MIN ORAL

10 Lee G, Cunningham J, Sidi S, **Zeng D**, Kong P, Ho A, Bondy S, Chambers A, Loughton S, Nakajima L, Kapoor V, Sapkota D, Kumal S. Participant attitudes towards a mixed-gender sexual health education program in rural Nepal.

> *Western Medical Students Summit*, Calgary, AB, Feb 2025 7-MIN ORAL

11 Sidi S, Kong P, Lee G, **Zeng D**, Ho A, Bondy S, Cunningham J, Chambers A, Loughton S, Sapkota D, Kumal S, Kapoor V, Nakajima L. Understanding adolescent mental health in rural Nepal: results of a mental health literacy needs assessment.

> *Western Medical Research Conference*, Carmel, CA, Jan 2025 10-MIN ORAL

POSTER

01 **Zeng D**, Wong VT, Pintwala R. Acute angle-closure glaucoma risk with non-ophthalmic anticholinergics: sex-stratified pharmacovigilance analysis.

> *American Academy of Ophthalmology (AAO)*, New Orleans, LA, Oct 2026
> POSTER PANEL DISCUSSION · 3-MIN ORAL

02 **Zeng D**, Bondok M, Tao B, Al-Ghoul A, Pintwala R. Ocular adverse events associated with taxane chemotherapy: a disproportionality analysis of pharmacovigilance data.

> *Canadian Ophthalmological Society (COS)*, Montréal, QC, Jun 2026
> *Association for Research in Vision and Ophthalmology (ARVO)*, Denver, CO, May 2026

03 **Zeng D**, Wong VT, Popovic M, Muni R, Pintwala R. Intraocular hemorrhage risk with antiplatelet agents: a pharmacovigilance analysis.

> *American Academy of Ophthalmology (AAO)*, New Orleans, LA, Oct 2026

04 **Zeng D**, Murray N. Orbital trauma on CT: a systematic checklist to reduce missed vision-threatening injuries.

> *American Society of Emergency Radiology (ASER)*, Nashville, TN, Oct 2026

05 **Zeng D**, Bates A, Zhang Y, Cook O, Raman S, Leung B, Ho C, Nunez JJ. Cumulative social isolation burden and overall survival in patients with cancer: a population-based cohort study.

> *American Society of Clinical Oncology (ASCO) Quality Care Symposium*, Boston, MA, Oct 2026
> CONQUER CANCER MERIT AWARD

06 Yuan L, **Zeng D**, Atrchian S, Clarke K, Sulpher J. Clinical outcomes of rectal squamous cell carcinoma in British Columbia, Canada.

> *European Society for Medical Oncology (ESMO) Gastrointestinal Cancers Congress*, Barcelona, Spain, Jul 2025
> *BC Cancer Summit*, Vancouver, BC, Nov 2025

07 Sagorin Z, **Zeng D**, Nguyen N, Yorke E, Sampath S. Postoperative ileus and incisional hernia: midline versus Pfannenstiel extraction site for laparoscopic right hemicolectomy with intracorporeal anastomosis.

> *Society of American Gastrointestinal and Endoscopic Surgeons (SAGES)*, Long Beach, CA, Mar 2025
> *Western Medical Students Summit*, Calgary, AB, Feb 2025

08 Li K, **Zeng D**, Thapar A, Belayneh M. Managing neuropathic cancer breakthrough pain for patients on methadone: a retrospective cohort study.

> *BC Cancer Summit*, Vancouver, BC, Nov 2025

09 **Zeng D**, Fortier AM, Park M. Targeting chemo-resistant triple-negative breast cancer.

> *Celebration of Research and Training in Oncology*, Montréal, QC, May 2022

10 Lee G, Cunningham J, Sidi S, **Zeng D**, Kong P, Ho A, Bondy S, Chambers A, Loughton S, Nakajima L, Kapoor V, Sapkota D, Kumal S. Participant attitudes towards a mixed-gender sexual health education program in rural Nepal.

> *Western Medical Research Conference*, Carmel, CA, Jan 2025

11 Qureshi Q, Geyer A, Tan D, Chen S, Feng N, **Zeng D**, Delaney G, Garden FL, McKenzie P, Yap ML, Chan J. Global patterns in actual radiotherapy utilization for cancer: a systematic review and meta-analysis.

> *Canadian Association of Radiation Oncology (CARO)*, St. John's, NL, Sept 2026

Research experiences

OPHTHALMOLOGY

Acute Angle-Closure Glaucoma (ACG) & Non-Ophthalmic Anticholinergics

Feb 2026 – present

Supervisors: Dr. Vincent Tony Wong, Dr. Rob Pintwala

- Leading a sex-stratified disproportionality analysis of ACG reporting in patients on non-ophthalmic anticholinergics, including sensitivity analyses in R

Intraocular Hemorrhage & Antiplatelet Use

Feb 2026 – present

Supervisors: Dr. Vincent Tony Wong, Dr. Rob Pintwala

- Integrating disproportionality signals with existing evidence to raise clinician awareness of intraocular bleeding risk, especially with clopidogrel and aspirin, independent of anticoagulant use

Taxane Chemotherapy-Associated Ocular Adverse Events

Sept 2025 – Aug 2026

Supervisors: Dr. Rob Pintwala, Dr. Ahmed Al-Ghoul

- Screened 258 ophthalmic outcomes for disproportionality signals using reporting odds ratios, chi-square, and the Bayesian information component (IC_{025})
- Critically evaluated gaps in evidence, sources of bias, and study limitations for a structured literature review to support rigorous interpretation of significant FAERS signals

Ophthalmic Surgical Wait Times

Apr 2026 – Jul 2026

Supervisor: Dr. Eduardo Navajas

- Investigated regional trends in ophthalmic surgical wait times across BC, with an emphasis on disparities in access for Indigenous communities
- Advocated for resource allocation to support more ophthalmic care in Indigenous communities

Intraocular Malignancy

Jun 2026 – present

- Collaborating with two medical students to screen 5,561 studies for a systematic review, resolving discrepancies by delegating tasks and communicating our decision-making process clearly

Visual Outcomes after Craniopharyngioma Surgery

Aug 2026 – present

- Screening 1,818 studies to determine predictors of visual improvement and deterioration after craniopharyngioma surgery; synthesizing findings for a systematic review

ONCOLOGY CARE

Social Isolation & Cancer Survival

Sept 2025 – Jul 2026

Supervisor: Dr. John-Jose Nunez

- Recent cancer diagnosis in my mother motivated me to research the effects of psychosocial factors such as the many dimensions of social isolation on cancer survival
- Led an analysis of a population cohort of 45,651 patients using Python; found that living alone, no regular social contact, and depressive or anxiety symptoms significantly increase mortality in cancer

Thymoma Survival & Recurrence

Oct 2025 – Sept 2026

Supervisor: Dr. Siavash Atrchian

- Using competing risks analysis, estimated the long-term survival and recurrence of thymoma in a population-based cohort in BC followed for up to 21 years

Global Radiotherapy Utilization

Sept 2025 – Jun 2026

Supervisor: Dr. Jessica Chan

- Screened 3,948 studies for a systematic review and meta-analysis comparing evidence-based radiotherapy need with real-world utilization
- Extracting detailed information to characterize global inequities in access to cancer care

Methadone for Breakthrough Neuropathic Cancer Pain

Nov 2024 – Sept 2026

Supervisor: Dr. Mathieos Belayneh

- Led a standardized chart review of 706 patients; identified methadone as the second-most common analgesic in BC for breakthrough neuropathic cancer pain
- Data supported continued use of methadone as there were no documented severe adverse events

Rectal Squamous Cell Carcinoma (rSCC) in BC

Apr 2024 – Jan 2026

Supervisor: Dr. Jeffrey Sulpher

- Collaborated with another medical student to analyze rSCC treatment patterns and outcomes in BC by standardizing data extraction and meeting regularly to resolve chart-review conflicts

Chemoprevention Strategies in Transplant Recipients

Dec 2025 – Jul 2026

Supervisor: Dr. Fatemeh Jafarian

- Investigated strategies associated with reduced cutaneous malignancy in solid organ transplant recipients
- Coordinated literature review and data extraction across a team of 5 medical students, delegating individual tasks to ensure smooth synthesis of evidence

SURGERY

Surgical Technique & Laparoscopic Right Hemicolectomy Outcomes

Feb 2024 – May 2026

Supervisor: Dr. Sharadh Sampath

- Led a standardized review of 203 patient charts; examined associations of anastomotic technique and specimen-extraction site with short-term postoperative ileus and long-term incisional hernia

Artificial Intelligence in Global Trauma Care

Mar 2026 – Jul 2026

Supervisor: Dr. Morad Hameed

- Spearheaded screening and data extraction of 1,046 studies for a systematic review of research priorities and gaps in artificial intelligence for trauma care in low-/middle-income countries

Determinants of Digit Survival after Replantation

Sept 2024 – Aug 2026

Supervisor: Dr. David Tang

- Detailed chart review and analyses of all digital replantation patients in BC over 10 years revealed that injury topography and postoperative complications are predictive of digit outcomes

BASIC & COMPUTATIONAL SCIENCE

Microglia in Neurodegeneration

Sept 2019 – Jun 2021

Supervisor: Dr. Julien Muffat

- Engineered doxycycline-inducible stem-cell models of microglial function using molecular cloning and CRISPR gene targeting, modelling mutant microglia with neurons

Cytokines in Acute Myeloid Leukemia

May 2019 – Sept 2020

Supervisor: Dr. Connie Eaves

- Investigated cytokine-driven transformation to acute myeloid leukemia in vitro and in vivo

Atherosclerosis COBWEB Model

Sept 2018 – Apr 2019

Supervisor: Dr. Brad Bass

- Developed 3 software models simulating blood-flow reduction across stages of atherosclerosis

Leadership & outreach

PATIENT ADVOCACY

Founder & Web Developer – Eyelingual

Jul 2026 – present

- Developed and launched Eyelingual, a web-based tool for conducting ophthalmic examinations across a language barrier when live interpreter services are unavailable
- Bridging inequities in access to ophthalmic care by supporting communication with patients who prefer care in a language other than English

Vision Mate – Canadian National Institute for the Blind (CNIB) Foundation

Sept 2025 – present

- Supported a client living with complete vision loss through biweekly home visits
- Built close rapport through companionship and practical assistance — reading mail, running errands, grocery shopping, and accompaniment on outings

Patient Outreach & Interview – Patient Experience Project

Oct 2024 – present

- Co-produced short films with patients sharing their lived experiences of illness and care
- Advocated for and secured their integration into the UBC MD curriculum, to foster a holistic understanding of illness and strengthen empathy for what patients live through

Newcomer Support – Refugee Health Initiative, UBC

Sept 2023 – May 2025

- Organized and delivered annual refugee-health outreach presentations at local community centres
- Provided a safe space and longitudinal support to a refugee family through monthly meetings, holding open discussion of resettlement challenges and adjustment

Client Support – Shelter Movers

Aug 2021 – present

- Worked in teams of 4–5 volunteers to move clients out of homes where they had experienced intimate partner violence, holding trauma-informed conversations where the client wanted them

Events Director – Women's Health Initiative, UBC

Aug 2024 – May 2025

- Designed a trauma-informed pelvic examination training session for medical students and co-led it with a physiotherapist

TEACHING & MENTORSHIP

Educational Exhibit – Orbital Trauma on CT

Feb 2026 – Jul 2026

- Worked with radiologist Dr. Nicolas Murray to develop a systematic checklist that ensures vision-threatening orbital injuries are recognized on trauma imaging; designed the formal exhibit

Sexual & Reproductive Health Program – Nepal Health Education, UBC

Oct 2023 – present

- Spearheaded changes to a sexual and reproductive health (SRH) education programme for adolescents in rural Nepal, based on local educator feedback, so the curriculum is culturally appropriate
- Designed and facilitated the formal programme evaluation; advocated for delivery to early adolescents, where larger health-literacy gains were demonstrated in pre-menstruation females
- Drafted thoroughly researched responses to commonly asked SRH questions

Mentorship & Shadowing Executive – Oncology Interest Group, UBC

Sept 2024 – present

- Coordinated and facilitated numerous oncologist-led mentorship and clinical shadowing placements for other medical students

Cultural Competency Training – Global Health Initiative, UBC

Oct 2024 – Jun 2025

- Facilitated sessions engaging other medical students in conversations on cultural humility before their global health projects, drawing on what I took away from my own visit to rural Nepal

Skills & memberships

SKILLS AND LANGUAGES

Statistical analysis	R, Python, SPSS; survival analysis (Kaplan–Meier, Cox proportional hazards, competing risks); FDA Adverse Event Reporting System (FAERS) disproportionality
Languages	English; Mandarin Chinese (native speaker)
Interests	Scuba diving — PADI Advanced Open Water, certified in Koh Tao, Thailand Running — completed half-marathons and the Vancouver Sun Run Karate — 20-minute skit with Karotid Chop, UBC's karate club, at the Med Gala Photography

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

Ophthalmology	Association for Research in Vision and Ophthalmology (ARVO) European Society of Cataract & Refractive Surgeons (ESCRS)
Oncology	American Society of Clinical Oncology (ASCO)